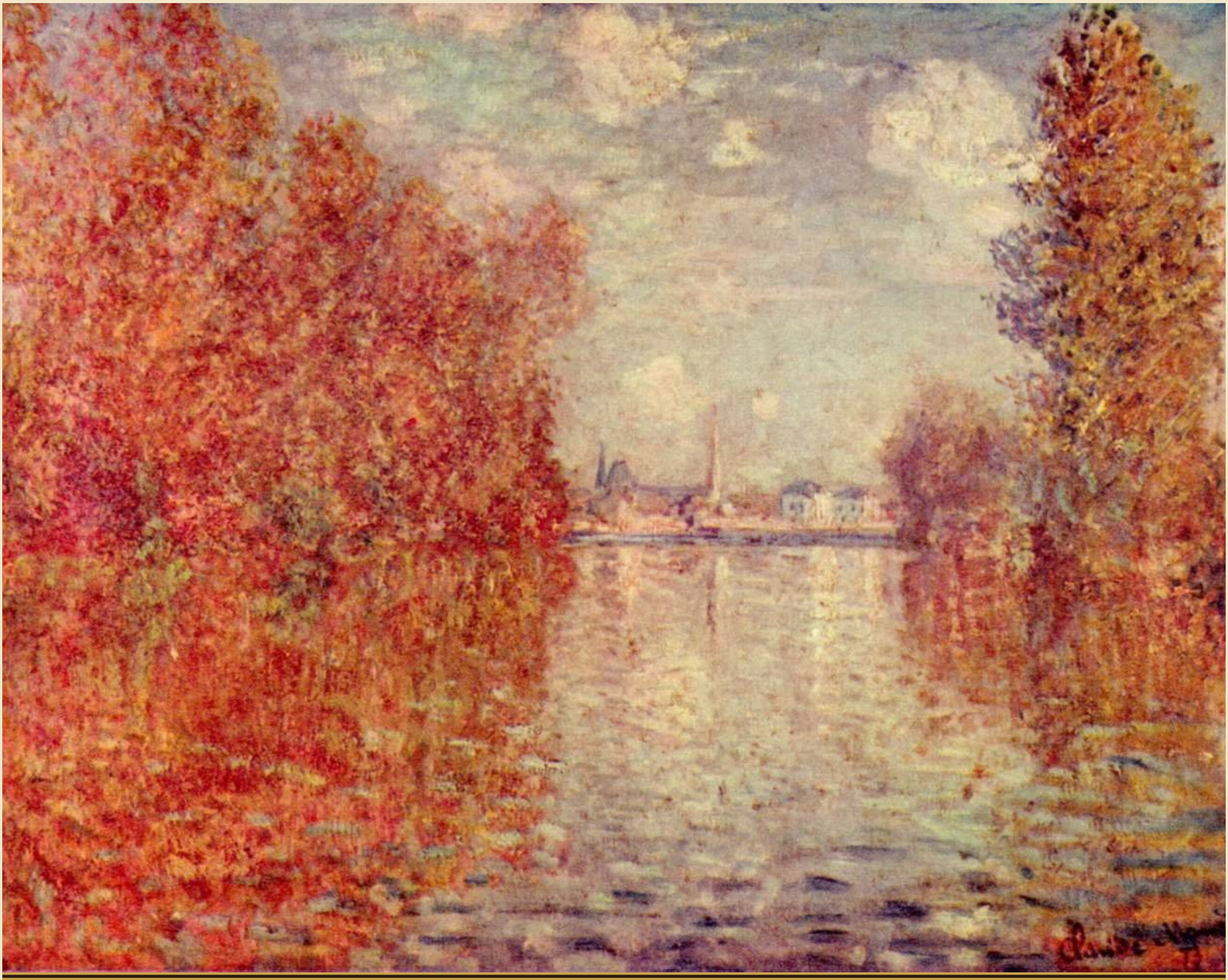


Siddhartha

Hermann Hesse · 1922

STUDENT PACKET

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

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Essential questions

- What does Siddhartha suggest about the search for self-knowledge?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about experience versus teaching?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the unity of all things?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the river and time?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about love and attachment?

Lesson 2: The Son of the Brahmin

Focus: restlessness despite privilege

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
ablution	*The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution.*	
ascetics	*I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*	
pristine	*Was not Atman in him, did not the pristine source spring from his heart?*	
invocation	*The sacrifices and the invocation of the gods were excellent—but was that all?*	
partaking	*For a long time, Siddhartha had been partaking in the discussions of the wise men, practising debate with Govinda, practising with Govinda the art of reflection, the service of meditation.*	
merciless	*Behind them blew a hot scent of quiet passion, of destructive service, of merciless self-denial.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   _____
   _____
2. How does Siddhartha's mother feel when she sees him walk, sit down and get up?
   _____
   _____
3. Whom does Siddhartha want to join?
   _____
   _____
4. What does the father see each time he looks through the chamber window during the night?
   _____
   _____
5. What does Siddhartha seek that rituals have not given him?
   _____
   _____
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Son of the Brahmin" in order, in one sentence each.
   _____
   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Son of the Brahmin"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "The Son of the Brahmin" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

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   _____

9. Reread: "Surely, many verses of the holy books, particularly in the Upanishades of Samaveda, spoke of this innermost and ultimate thing, wonderful verses." What does "particularly" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

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10. Reread: "silent and motionless sat the father on the mat, and the stars traced their paths in the sky." What does "traced" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "The Son of the Brahmin" suggest about restlessness despite privilege? State the inference and the line that supports it.

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2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

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3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about restlessness despite privilege?

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4. In the passage that begins "After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose.", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

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5. What causes the main turn in "The Son of the Brahmin", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

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6. As the opening chapter, what does “The Son of the Brahmin” set up that the rest of Siddhartha will need?
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7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?
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8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?
   _____
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   _____
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?
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   _____
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   _____
10. Background: Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of… How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Son of the Brahmin" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about restlessness despite privilege?

4. Write three questions of your own about "The Son of the Brahmin": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.

5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.

7. Compare how "The Son of the Brahmin" treats restlessness despite privilege with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?

8. Predict what "With the Samanas" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about restlessness despite privilege?

_____

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10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

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Chapter quiz

1. Complete the quotation from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 13: "They went to the _____ tree, they sat down, Siddhartha right here, Govinda twenty paces away."

   Word bank: river, temple, banyan, market

   Answer: _____

2. In the line "The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution.", what does "ablution" most nearly mean?

   A. a person left stranded after a shipwreck

   B. a ritual washing of the body

   C. a tank for storing water

   D. people who punish themselves for their sins

3. Before Siddhartha leaves, what does his father ask him to do?

   A. Give away his fine clothes to the poor of the town

   B. Wait one more day and sleep before he goes

   C. Pray at the temple with the Brahmins first

   D. Kiss his mother and tell her where he is going

4. In the line "I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.", what does "ascetics" most nearly mean?

   A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons

   B. steadiness of mind under stress

   C. a trait of dignified seriousness

   D. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

5. Which word completes this sentence from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 9? "all knowledge of the wisest ones had been collected here in _____ words, pure as honey collected by bees."

   A. muddy

   B. magic

   C. rusty

   D. wooden

6. Complete the quotation from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 5: "he would not become a common Brahmin, not a lazy _____ in charge of offerings;"
   Answer: _____
7. What do the three Samanas who pass through the town look like?
   A. Skinny, withered and almost naked
   B. Fat, rich and finely dressed
   C. Young men laughing and singing songs
   D. Old men riding on oxcarts
8. In the line "Was not Atman in him, did not the pristine source spring from his heart?", what does "pristine" most nearly mean?
   A. original; existing from the very beginning
   B. strikingly unusual or odd
   C. too bold or forward; presumptuous
   D. occurring or operating at the same time
9. Complete the quotation from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 50: "He put his _____ back under control, bowed to his father, and went to his mother to do as his father had said."
   Word bank: ladders, pebbles, limbs, kettles
   Answer: _____
10. Complete the quotation from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 22: "Siddhartha entered the chamber, where his father was sitting on a _____ of bast."
    Word bank: mat, horse, roof, boat
    Answer: _____
11. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Behind them blew a hot scent of quiet passion, of destructive service, of _____ self-denial."
    Word bank: gentle, merciless, lazy, comfortable
    Answer: _____
12. What can you infer from this line? "Did he not, again and again, have to drink from holy sources, as a thirsty man, from the offerings, from the books, from the disputes of the Brahmins?" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
13. Which of these passages comes earliest in The Son of the Brahmin?
    A. "But more than all the others he was loved by Govinda, his friend, the son of a Brahmin."
    B. "Joy leapt in his father's heart for his son who was quick to learn,…"
    C. "Love touched the hearts of the Brahmins' young daughters when Siddhartha walked through the lanes of the town with the luminous forehead,…"
    D. "Bliss leapt in his mother's breast when she saw him, when she saw him walking, when she saw him sit down and get up, Siddhartha, strong,…"

14. Analyze the word choice in “Early tomorrow morning, my friend, Siddhartha will go to the Samanas. He will become a Samana.” (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 17). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    _____

    _____

    _____

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    _____

15. Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Siddhartha leaves home not because his life is bad but because no one around him has found what he seeks.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    _____

    _____

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Writing prompt

Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 3: With the Samanas

Focus: self-denial as a path

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
numbing	*It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.*	
nirvana	*And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.*	
festering	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	
cowered	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	
thirsted	*I always thirsted for knowledge, I have always been full of questions.*	
mumbled	*And Govinda mumbled a verse to himself, a verse from an Upanishad:*	
meditate	*He'll turn seventy and eighty, and you and me, we will grow just as old and will do our exercises, and will fast, and will meditate.*	
teachings	*Verily, this made my chest ache when I breathed, and thought to myself: If only I would too, if only we both would too, Siddhartha and me, live to see the hour when we will hear the teachings from the mouth of this perfected man!*	
scorned	*But his enemies and disbelievers said, this Gotama was a vain seducer, he would spent his days in luxury, scorned the offerings, was without learning, and knew neither exercises nor self-castigation.*	
embarrassed	*Govinda was startled and became embarrassed.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What do the Samanas practice?

   _____

   _____

2. What can Siddhartha do in meditation?

   _____

   _____

3. What does he conclude about these practices?

4. Who is rumored to have attained enlightenment?
5. How does Siddhartha respond to the old Samana's anger?
6. Retell the three most important events of "With the Samanas" in order, in one sentence each.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "With the Samanas"? Name two and one thing each says or does.
8. Where and when does "With the Samanas" take place? Point to the line that tells you.
9. Reread: "How could you have learned meditation, holding your breath, insensitivity against hunger and pain there among these wretched people?" What does "insensitivity" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?
10. Reread: "And the young men returned the bows with thanks, returned the wish, went on their way with salutations." What does "salutations" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

Inferential

1. What does "With the Samanas" suggest about self-denial as a path? State the inference and the line that supports it.
2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about self-denial as a path?

4. In the passage that begins “Many wonderful and unbelievable things were reported of him, he had performed miracles, had overcome the devil, had spoken to the gods.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “With the Samanas”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “With the Samanas” build on “The Son of the Brahmin”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching?

10. Background: Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: "Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of "With the Samanas" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about self-denial as a path?
   _____
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   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about "With the Samanas": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how "With the Samanas" treats self-denial as a path with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

8. Predict what "Gotama" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about self-denial as a path?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Chapter quiz

1. How often does Siddhartha eat while he lives with the Samanas?

   A. Rice and fresh fruit three times each day

   B. Only what Govinda cooks for him

   C. Only once a day, never anything cooked

   D. Nothing but milk and honey

2. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He'll turn seventy and eighty, and you and me, we will grow just as old and will do our exercises, and will fast, and will _____."

   Word bank: feast, meditate, gamble, trade

   Answer: _____

3. Which word completes this sentence from With the Samanas, paragraph 32? "The myth had also _____ the Samanas in the forest, and also Siddhartha, and also Govinda, slowly, drop by drop, every drop laden with hope, every drop laden with doubt."

   A. forgotten

   B. avoided

   C. reached

   D. frightened

4. In the line "It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.", what does "numbing" most nearly mean?

   A. a boat that carries people across water

   B. chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food

   C. tricks; false appearances

   D. a temporary loss of sensation

5. According to paragraph 2, what is the longest Siddhartha fasts?
   A. Twenty-eight days
   B. Three days
   C. One hundred days
   D. A single day
6. Complete the quotation from With the Samanas, paragraph 1: "In the evening of this day they caught up with the ascetics, the skinny Samanas, and offered them their _____ and—obedience."
   Word bank: money, companionship, scorn, weapons
   Answer: _____
7. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "And Govinda _____ a verse to himself, a verse from an Upanishad:"
   Word bank: shouted, forgot, tore, mumbled
   Answer: _____
8. Where does Siddhartha say he could have learned the Samanas' arts more quickly?
   A. In the taverns, among carters and gamblers
   B. In his father's house, from the holy books
   C. In the city, from the merchants
   D. In the temple, from the priests
9. Complete the quotation from With the Samanas, paragraph 5: "learned to _____ the beats of his heart, until they were only a few and almost none."
   Word bank: reduce, paint, bake, knit
   Answer: _____
10. Which word completes this sentence from With the Samanas, paragraph 15? "But that I, Siddhartha, find only a short numbing of the senses in my exercises and _____ and that I am just as far removed from wisdom, from salvation, as a child in the mother's womb, this I know, O Govinda, this I know."
    A. feasts
    B. meditations
    C. riches
    D. games
11. In the line "the return was inevitable, inescapable was the hour, when he found himself back in the sunshine or in the moonlight", what does "inescapable" most nearly mean?
    A. easy to forget
    B. pleasant to wait for
    C. hidden from sight
    D. impossible to avoid
12. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Verily, this made my chest ache when I breathed, and thought to myself: If only I would too, if only we both would too, Siddhartha and me, live to see the hour when we will hear the _____ from the mouth of this perfected man!"
    Word bank: insults, teachings, lies, threats
    Answer: _____

13. What can you infer from this line? “his mouth twitched with contempt when he walked through a city of nicely dressed people” (With the Samanas, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

14. What can you infer from this line? “A dead jackal was lying on the sandy bank” (With the Samanas, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

15. Claim: Siddhartha rejects the Samanas because their techniques escape the self rather than understanding it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “What I’ve learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means” (With the Samanas, paragraph 11).

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Writing prompt

Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 4: Gotama

Focus: the teacher and the teaching

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
novices	*Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.*	
discard	*There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.*	
enticed	*No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*	
venerated	*Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one.*	
exhaled	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	
glistened	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	
openness	*With half of a smile, with an unwavering openness and kindness, Gotama looked into the stranger's eyes and bid him to leave with a hardly noticeable gesture.*	
equanimity	*The Buddha's eyes quietly looked to the ground; quietly, in perfect equanimity his inscrutable face was smiling.*	
dangling	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	
politely	*"As you please," the venerable one spoke politely.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Where do they hear Gotama teach?

   _____

   _____

2. What does Govinda decide?

   _____

   _____

3. What does Siddhartha tell Gotama?

   _____

   _____

4. What does Gotama warn Siddhartha about?

   _____

   _____

5. How do the two Samanas find a place to sleep at the crowded Jetavana?

   _____

   _____

6. Retell the three most important events of "Gotama" in order, in one sentence each.

   _____

   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Gotama"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "Gotama" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "Quoth Siddhartha: 'Yesterday, O exalted one, I had been privileged to hear your wondrous teachings.'" What does "privileged" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "he exclaimed lamentingly." What does "lamentingly" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "Gotama" suggest about the teacher and the teaching? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

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   _____

3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the teacher and the teaching?

   _____

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4. In the passage that begins “The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “Gotama”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “Gotama” build on “With the Samanas”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the unity of all things?

10. Background: Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: "The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of "Gotama" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the teacher and the teaching?
   _____
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   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about "Gotama": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
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   _____
5. Connect this chapter to teaching versus experience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
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6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
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7. Compare how "Gotama" treats the teacher and the teaching with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
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8. Predict what "Awakening" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

   _____

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   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the teacher and the teaching?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Chapter quiz

1. Who tells the two Samanas where the Buddha is staying?
   A. A woman who gives them food in Savathi
   B. A monk at the gate of the grove
   C. A merchant on the long road to the town
   D. A child playing beside the river

2. Complete the quotation from Gotama, paragraph 36: "You've heard the _____, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply"
   Answer: _____

3. In the line "Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.", what does "novices" most nearly mean?
   A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons
   B. understandings; realizations
   C. beginners in a religious order
   D. the quality of being united into one

4. Which word completes this sentence from Gotama, paragraph 11? "Attentively, Govinda looked at the monk in the yellow robe, who seemed to be in no way _____ from the hundreds of other monks."
   A. hungry
   B. absent
   C. missing
   D. different

5. According to the woman, in whose garden does the Buddha dwell?
   A. The king's
   B. Anathapindika's
   C. The Brahmins'
   D. Govinda's father's
6. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But in the evening, when the heat cooled down and everyone in the camp started to _____ about and gathered around, they heard the Buddha teaching."
   Word bank: bustle, sneeze, knit, paint
   Answer: _____
7. In the line "There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.", what does "discard" most nearly mean?
   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking
   B. to return (a feeling)
   C. to cut apart in order to examine closely
   D. to reject; to throw away
8. Complete the quotation from Gotama, paragraph 17: "They heard his voice, and it was also perfected, was of perfect calmness, was full of _____."
   Word bank: peace, anger, fear, doubt
   Answer: _____
9. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: Gotama's whole body seemed to speak his truth: "… spoke of, breathed of, _____ the fragrant of, glistened of truth."
   Word bank: shouted, exhaled, argued, denied
   Answer: _____
10. Which word completes this sentence from Gotama, paragraph 4? "There you pilgrims shall spent the night, for there is enough space for the _____, who flock here, …"
    A. uninterested
    B. innumerable
    C. solitary
    D. departed
11. Which choice best states how "Gotama" ends?
    A. Siddhartha and Govinda both take the vows
    B. Govinda leaves the order to follow his friend
    C. Gotama asks Siddhartha to stay and teach
    D. Siddhartha leaves alone to learn from himself
12. What does Siddhartha grant the Buddha's teaching before he objects? Use this line. "… it teaches many to live righteously, to avoid evil." (Gotama, paragraph 37)

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

13. Which literary element does this describe in "Gotama"? In his talk with Gotama, Siddhartha's polite praise and firm refusal show both his respect and his independence.
    A. Personification
    B. Characterization
    C. Hyperbole
    D. Alliteration
14. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one" (Gotama, paragraph 15) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
15. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "But be warned, O seeker of knowledge, of the thicket of opinions and of arguing about words" (Gotama, paragraph 36) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Writing prompt

Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 5: Awakening

Focus: awakening to the world

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
dissect	*I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.*	
inhaled	*Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.*	
deceptions	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	
strides	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	
symbols	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	
coincidence	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	
awakened	*No, this is over, I have awakened, I have indeed awakened and have not been born before this very day."*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?

   _____

   _____

2. Who, Siddhartha thinks, is as alone as he is?

   _____

   _____

3. What does he feel after the awakening?

   _____

   _____

4. Does Siddhartha go home to his father?

   _____

_____

5. What idea does he reject here?

   _____

   _____

6. Retell the three most important events of "Awakening" in order, in one sentence each.

   _____

   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Awakening"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "Awakening" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "Slowly walking along, Siddhartha pondered." What does "pondered" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "Motionless, Siddhartha remained standing there, and for the time of one moment and breath, his heart felt cold" What does "motionless" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "Awakening" suggest about awakening to the world? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about awakening to the world?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

4. In the passage that begins "Having been pondering while slowly walking along, he now stopped as these thoughts caught hold of him, and right away another thought sprang forth from these, a new thought, which…", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

   _____

5. What causes the main turn in “Awakening”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?
6. How does “Awakening” build on “Gotama”? Name one link of cause and effect.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for the self?
10. Background: In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.

3. Rewrite one moment of "Awakening" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about awakening to the world?

4. Write three questions of your own about "Awakening": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.

5. Connect this chapter to love and attachment: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?

6. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.

7. Compare how "Awakening" treats awakening to the world with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?

8. Predict what "Kamala" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

_____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about awakening to the world?

_____

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_____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

_____

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Chapter quiz

1. Complete the quotation from Awakening, paragraph 11: "he felt a cold in his chest, as a small animal, a bird or a _____, would when seeing how alone he was."
   Word bank: rabbit, kettle, candle, ladder
   Answer: _____
2. In paragraph 4, what feeling does Siddhartha say made him flee from himself?
   A. Pride in his learning
   B. Boredom with the Vedas
   C. Grief for his mother
   D. Fear of himself
3. Complete the quotation from Awakening, paragraph 6: "I do not want to kill and _____ myself any longer, to find a secret behind the ruins."
   Word bank: praise, feed, honour, dissect
   Answer: _____
4. In the line "And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home", what does "impatiently" most nearly mean?
   A. unable to wait calmly
   B. slowly and carefully
   C. sadly and wearily
   D. quietly and rather shyly
5. How does the world appear to Siddhartha after his awakening?
   A. Grey and dull
   B. Frightening and dark
   C. Unreal, like a dream
   D. New and beautiful
6. Which teachers does Siddhartha say will teach him no more?
   A. His father, his mother and his friend Govinda

B. The merchants of the city

C. Yoga-Veda, Atharva-Veda and the ascetics

D. The Buddha's monks alone

7. In paragraph 3, what does Siddhartha say his teachers were unable to teach him?

A. How to fast and wait

B. The self he sought to learn about

C. The verses of the Vedas

D. How to read and write

8. In the line "to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior", what does "interior" most nearly mean?

A. the inner part; the inside

B. the outer covering

C. a distant country

D. a sudden loss

9. In paragraph 6, with what does Siddhartha say he no longer wants to begin his thoughts and his life?

A. With the teachings of Gotama

B. With money and the life of the city

C. With Atman and the suffering of the world

D. With the Vedas and the offerings to the gods

10. Which choice best states a central concern of "Awakening"?

A. Seeing the visible world anew

B. The teacher and the teaching

C. The pain of a father's love

D. Detachment among the childlike people

11. Which of these passages comes earliest in Awakening?

A. "He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along."

B. "When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this…"

C. "He realized that one thing had left him, as a snake is left by its old skin, that one thing no longer existed in him, which had accompanied…"

D. "He realized that he was no youth any more, but had turned into a man."

12. What does Siddhartha realize has occupied him most? Use this line. "Truly, no thing in this world has kept my thoughts thus busy, as this my very own self, this mystery of me being alive, of me being one and being separated and isolated from all others, of me being Siddhartha!" (Awakening, paragraph 3)

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

13. Which literary element does this describe in "Awakening"? The chapter is one walk and one long meditation: each time Siddhartha stops on the path, a new realization comes. Hesse marks the turns

physically ('Siddhartha stopped once again, suddenly, as if there was a snake lying in front of him on the path').

A. Structure

B. Allusion

C. Alliteration

D. Theme

14. Analyze the word choice in "There was no nobleman who did not belong to the noblemen, no worker that did not belong to the workers, and found refuge with them, shared their life, spoke their language." (Awakening, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

_____

_____

_____

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_____

15. Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Siddhartha's awakening is a decision to find meaning in himself and in the visible world rather than behind it, and it leaves him utterly alone." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

_____

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Writing prompt

Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 6: Kamala

Focus: entering the city and learning love

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
disembarking	*"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.*	
seashells	*In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.*	
shimmered	*It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.—When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*	
pouches	*Many young men come to me, and there are also sons of Brahmins among them, but they come in beautiful clothes, they come in fine shoes, they have perfume in their hair and money in their pouches.*	
cistern	*Differently the sun burnt the head, differently the shade of the forest cooled him down, differently the stream and the cistern, the pumpkin and the banana tasted.*	
rainbows	*He saw trees, stars, animals, clouds, rainbows, rocks, herbs, flowers, stream and river, the glistening dew in the bushes in the morning, distant high mountains which were blue and pale, birds sang and bees, wind silverishly blew through the rice field.*	
clanged	*Kamala loudly clapped her hands, so that the golden bracelets clanged.*	
jackals	*"Why should I be afraid of a Samana, a stupid Samana from the forest, who is coming from the jackals and doesn't even know yet what women are?"*	
peacocks	*Kamala smiled, played with her fan of peacocks' feathers, and asked: "And only to tell me this, Siddhartha has come to me?"*	
courtesan	*When, late in the afternoon, beautiful Kamala approached her grove in her sedan-chair, Siddhartha was standing at the entrance, made a bow and received the courtesan's greeting.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?

   _____

   _____

2. Whom does the ferryman remind Siddhartha of as they part?

   _____

   _____

3. Where does Siddhartha go on the day after his first visit to Kamala?

   _____

   _____

4. What three skills does Siddhartha name?

   _____

   _____

5. Who gives Siddhartha work?

   _____

   _____

6. Retell the three most important events of "Kamala" in order, in one sentence each.

   _____

   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Kamala"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "Kamala" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "In their midst, carried by four servants in an ornamental sedan-chair, sat a woman, the mistress, on red pillows under a colourful canopy." What does "ornamental" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "Who wouldn't like to give advice to a poor, ignorant Samana, who is coming from the jackals of the forest?" What does "ignorant" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "Kamala" suggest about entering the city and learning love? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about entering the city and learning love?

4. In the passage that begins "'I thank you, my benefactor,'", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in "Kamala", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does "Kamala" build on "Awakening"? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: "Siddhartha says he can think, wait and fast. Why are these powerful skills?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with love and attachment?

10. Background: Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

_____
_____
_____

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of “Kamala” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about entering the city and learning love?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about “Kamala”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the search for self-knowledge: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
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   _____
6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
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7. Compare how “Kamala” treats entering the city and learning love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____

_____

_____

_____

8. Predict what "With the Childlike People" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

_____

_____

_____

_____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about entering the city and learning love?

_____

_____

_____

_____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

_____

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_____

Chapter quiz

1. Complete the quotation from Kamala, paragraph 16: "Before the city, in a _____ fenced grove, the traveller came across a small group of servants, both male and female, carrying baskets."

   Word bank: beautifully, poorly, barely, badly

   Answer: _____

2. Complete the quotation from Kamala, paragraph 11: "This too, I have learned from the river: _____ is coming back"

   Answer: _____

3. Which word completes this sentence from Kamala, paragraph 18? "He instantly felt drawn into the grove, but he thought about it, and only now he became aware of how the servants and maids had looked at him at the entrance, how despicable, how _____, how rejecting."

   A. distrustful

   B. affectionate

   C. cheerful

   D. generous

4. Complete the quotation from Kamala, paragraph 2: "All of this had always _____, and he had not seen it; he had not been with it."

   Word bank: vanished, perished, ended, existed

   Answer: _____

5. In the line "In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.", what does "seashells" most nearly mean?
   A. a dulling of feeling or pain
   B. the shells of sea creatures
   C. frankness; honesty
   D. someone who rows a boat
6. In the line "'I thank you, my benefactor,' spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.", what does "disembarking" most nearly mean?
   A. getting off a boat
   B. washing or soaking in water
   C. showing clearly
   D. weighing down with a load
7. Which word completes this sentence from Kamala, paragraph 3? "No, this world of thought was also still on this side, and nothing could be achieved by killing the random self of the senses, if the random self of thoughts and learned _____ was fattened on the other hand."
   A. hunger
   B. silence
   C. knowledge
   D. obedience
8. What does the ferryman say he loves more than anything?
   A. His bamboo raft
   B. The river
   C. His straw hut
   D. The large city
9. What does Siddhartha ask the young woman washing clothes at the stream?
   A. Whether she has seen Govinda
   B. How far it still is to the large city
   C. Where the Buddha is teaching now
   D. Whether he may sleep in her hut
10. What does Siddhartha call his first sight of Kamala as he nears the city?
    A. A warning from the gods
    B. A test of his vows
    C. A charming omen
    D. A bad sign for his journey
11. What can you infer from this line? "So it is settled: Siddhartha will return, once he'll have what he still lacks: clothes, shoes, money." (Kamala, paragraph 38) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    _____

    _____

    _____

_____

_____

12. What does Siddhartha learn about the woman in the grove from the next person on the path?
    A. That she is a priestess of the grove
    B. That she is the wife of a rich king
    C. That she is a merchant's widow
    D. That she is a famous courtesan
13. What does Siddhartha watch at the pleasure-garden, and what does it show about him? "Siddhartha stopped at the entrance to the pleasure-garden and watched the parade, saw the servants, the maids, the baskets, saw the sedan-chair and saw the lady in it." (Kamala, paragraph 16)

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____
14. Which literary element does this describe in "Kamala"? Siddhartha enters the world: the ferryman carries him across for nothing; a young village woman offers herself and he declines; he sees the courtesan Kamala and decides she will be his teacher of love.
    A. Irony
    B. Characterization
    C. Symbolism
    D. Hyperbole
15. Synthesis: trace how teaching versus experience develops from Gotama to Kamala. Use one quotation from each.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Writing prompt

Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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_____

Lesson 7: With the Childlike People

Focus: detachment among the childlike people

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
hastiness	*But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*	
admonished	*At times he felt, deep in his chest, a dying, quiet voice, which admonished him quietly, lamented quietly; he hardly perceived it.*	
carpets	*Siddhartha went to Kamaswami the merchant, he was directed into a rich house, servants led him between precious carpets into a chamber, where he awaited the master of the house.*	
calmness	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What does Siddhartha tell Kamaswami about how he has lived for the past three years?
   _____
   _____
2. What does he call ordinary people?
   _____
   _____
3. How does Kamaswami feel about Siddhartha's attitude?
   _____
   _____
4. When Siddhartha says that few people have an inner refuge, what reason does Kamala give?
   _____
   _____
5. How does Siddhartha respond to Kamaswami's business worries?
   _____
   _____
6. Retell the three most important events of "With the Childlike People" in order, in one sentence each.
   _____
   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "With the Childlike People"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "With the Childlike People" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "These are your areas of expertise." What does "expertise" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "But daily, at the hour appointed by her, he visited beautiful Kamala, wearing pretty clothes, fine shoes, and soon he brought her gifts as well." What does "appointed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "With the Childlike People" suggest about detachment among the childlike people? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about detachment among the childlike people?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

4. In the passage that begins "Siddhartha went to Kamaswami the merchant, he was directed into a rich house, servants led him between precious carpets into a chamber, where he awaited the master of the house.", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

5. What causes the main turn in “With the Childlike People”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

6. How does “With the Childlike People” build on “Kamala”? Name one link of cause and effect.

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

10. Background: Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.

   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.

3. Rewrite one moment of "With the Childlike People" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about detachment among the childlike people?

4. Write three questions of your own about "With the Childlike People": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.

5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.

7. Compare how "With the Childlike People" treats detachment among the childlike people with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?

8. Predict what "Sansara" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about detachment among the childlike people?

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10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

_____

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Chapter quiz

1. What is ironic about Siddhartha's view of the people of the town?
   A. He is poorer than them
   B. They can love, and he cannot
   C. He was born among them
   D. He does not truly see them at all
2. Siddhartha calls ordinary people childlike. What does that name suggest about how he sees them?
   A. He sees them as lost in games he stands above
   B. He sees them as wiser than he is himself
   C. He sees them as dangerous enemies to be avoided
   D. He sees them as holy innocents to imitate
3. Complete the quotation from With the Childlike People, paragraph 28: "Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him _____."
   Word bank: mercy, pity, calculations, prayers
   Answer: _____
4. Which word completes this sentence from With the Childlike People, paragraph 6? "I am without _____,' said Siddhartha, 'if this is what you mean."
   A. eyes
   B. possessions
   C. hands
   D. skin
5. Complete the quotation from With the Childlike People, paragraph 20: "When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the _____ thing he could do."
   Word bank: smartest, worst, silliest, rudest
   Answer: _____
6. In the line "He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of…", what does "calmness" most nearly mean?
   A. chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food
   B. a lifetime in a particular body

C. understandings; realizations

D. steadiness of mind under stress

7. Complete the quotation from With the Childlike People, paragraph 42: "Most people, Kamala, are like a _____ leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground"

   Word bank: falling, glass, iron, stone

   Answer: _____

8. Complete the quotation from With the Childlike People, paragraph 21: "You're right, Samana. Wait for a _____."

   Word bank: moment, kettle, ladder, pebble

   Answer: _____

9. Where does Siddhartha tell Kamaswami he has come from?

   A. From his father's house

   B. From the Samanas

   C. From Gotama's grove

   D. From the ferryman's hut

10. In the line "Siddhartha went to Kamaswami the merchant, he was directed into a rich house, servants led him between precious carpets into a chamber, where he awaited the master of the house.", what does "carpets" most nearly mean?

    A. thick woven floor coverings

    B. a boat that carries people across water

    C. a person left stranded after a shipwreck

    D. small bags for carrying money or things

11. What does Siddhartha soon start bringing Kamala on his daily visits?

    A. Rice from the village

    B. Gifts

    C. Letters from Kamaswami

    D. Flowers from the forest

12. Which choice best states a central concern of "With the Childlike People"?

    A. Learning to listen from the flowing river

    B. The teacher and the teaching

    C. Playing at worldly life with no heart

    D. The pain of a father's love

13. What can you infer from this line? "But he has that mysterious quality of those people to whom success comes all by itself, whether this may be a good star of his birth, magic, or something he has learned among Samanas." (With the Childlike People, paragraph 30) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

14. How does Siddhartha deal with Kamaswami's worries? Use this line. "Siddhartha never listened to Kamaswami's worries and Kamaswami had many worries." (With the Childlike People, paragraph 36)

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

15. Analyze the word choice in "Perhaps people of our kind can't love" (With the Childlike People, paragraph 47). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Writing prompt

Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 8: Sansara

Focus: the cycle of desire

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
gambled	*Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.*	
castaway	*Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*	
demonstrating	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	
mockingly	*He played the game due to a pain of his heart, losing and wasting his wretched money in the game brought him an angry joy, in no other way he could demonstrate his disdain for wealth, the merchants' false god, more clearly and more mockingly.*	
zealously	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	
debtors	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	
encompassed	*Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness.*	
poultry	*He had learned to eat tenderly and carefully prepared food, even fish, even meat and poultry, spices and sweets, and to drink wine, which causes sloth and forgetfulness.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Which line shows how Siddhartha used to look down on the childlike people? Read it to us.

   _____

   _____

2. Why does the dream about the songbird shake Siddhartha so deeply?

   _____

   _____

3. What does Kamala do when she hears that Siddhartha has disappeared?

   _____

   _____

4. What does Siddhartha do in his mind as he sits under the tree after the dream?

   _____

   _____

5. What is Sansara?

   _____

   _____

6. Retell the three most important events of "Sansara" in order, in one sentence each.

   _____

   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Sansara"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "Sansara" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "Just slowly and imperceptibly, as the harvest seasons and rainy seasons passed by, his mockery had become more tired, his superiority had become more quiet." What does "imperceptibly" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "On a strange and devious way, Siddhartha had gotten into this final and most base of all dependencies, by means of the game of dice." What does "devious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "Sansara" suggest about the cycle of desire? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the cycle of desire?

   _____

   _____

4. In the passage that begins “She had asked him to tell her about Gotama, and could not hear enough of him, how clear his eyes, how still and beautiful his mouth, how kind his smile, how peaceful his walk had been.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.
5. What causes the main turn in “Sansara”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?
6. How does “Sansara” build on “With the Childlike People”? Name one link of cause and effect.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the dead songbird symbolize?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching?
10. Background: Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of “Sansara” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the cycle of desire?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about “Sansara”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how “Sansara” treats the cycle of desire with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

8. Predict what "By the River" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cycle of desire?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Chapter quiz

1. Complete the quotation from Sansara, paragraph 5: "He only noticed that this bright and _____ voice inside of him, which had awoken in him at that time and had ever guided him in his best times, had become silent."

   Word bank: reliable, false, lying, rasping

   Answer: _____

2. In the line "Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.", what does "castaway" most nearly mean?

   A. a person left stranded after a shipwreck

   B. people who punish themselves for their sins

   C. perfumed oils and creams

   D. a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service

3. Complete the quotation from Sansara, paragraph 10: "Kamala owned a small, rare _____ bird in a golden cage. Of this bird he dreamt"

   Word bank: mooing, roaring, singing, barking

   Answer: _____

4. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?

   A. He becomes a ferryman on the river

   B. He becomes poor

   C. He becomes a holy man

   D. He becomes greedy and weary

5. In the line "in no other way he could demonstrate his disdain for wealth, the merchants' false god, more clearly and more mockingly.", what does "mockingly" most nearly mean?
   A. with appreciation; in a grateful manner
   B. with great energy and eagerness
   C. in a wonderful, marvellous way
   D. in a scornful, jeering way
6. Complete the quotation from Sansara, paragraph 4: "When Kamaswami was ailing, when he was annoyed, when he felt _____, when he was vexed by his worries as a merchant, Siddhartha had always watched it with mockery."
   Word bank: insulted, cheerful, delighted, grateful
   Answer: _____
7. Which word completes this sentence from Sansara, paragraph 4? "But he did not learn this from them, this out of all things, this joy of a child and this _____ of a child; he learned from them out of all things the unpleasant ones, which he himself despised."
   A. foolishness
   B. patience
   C. dignity
   D. silence
8. Complete the quotation from Sansara, paragraph 8: "He had spent the hours of the evening with Kamala, in her beautiful _____."
   Word bank: prison, pleasure-garden, shipyard, quarry
   Answer: _____
9. Complete the quotation from Sansara, paragraph 6: "He was a feared _____, few dared to take him on"
   Answer: _____
10. How does Siddhartha leave the city?
    A. On a ship
    B. With Kamala
    C. Suddenly, without a word
    D. With a great farewell feast
11. Which choice best states a central concern of "Sansara"?
    A. Awakening to the world
    B. Detachment among the childlike people
    C. Learning to listen from the flowing river
    D. The cycle of desire
12. What can you infer from this line? "few dared to take him on, so high and audacious were his stakes" (Sansara, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

13. In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? “to drink wine, which causes sloth and forgetfulness” (Sansara, paragraph 4) Name the theme and explain in two or three sentences, quoting the text.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

14. Which literary element does this describe in “Sansara”? The dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage: his inner voice has gone silent.

    A. Conflict

    B. Imagery

    C. Allusion

    D. Alliteration

15. Analyze how this simile shows Siddhartha's decline. “Just as a potter’s wheel, once it has been set in motion, will keep on turning for a long time and only slowly lose its vigour and come to a stop” (Sansara, paragraph 3)

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Writing prompt

Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

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Lesson 9: By the River

Focus: despair and renewal by the river

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
ointments	*There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.*	
unlearn	*I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*	
penitents	*But as a young man, I followed the penitents, lived in the forest, suffered of heat and frost, learned to hunger, taught my body to become dead.*	
annihilating	*so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body!*	
oneness	*Wonderfully, soon afterwards, insight came towards me in the form of the great Buddha's teachings, I felt the knowledge of the oneness of the world circling in me like my own blood.*	
gratefully	*He thought these thoughts, listened with a smile to his stomach, listened gratefully to a buzzing bee.*	
boasted	*In those days, so he remembered, he had boasted of three things to Kamala, had been able to do three noble and undefeatable feats: fasting—waiting—thinking.*	
retreated	*Into being a priest, into this arrogance, into this spirituality, his self had retreated, there it sat firmly and grew, while he thought he would kill it by fasting and penance.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river?

   _____

   _____

2. What stops him?

   _____

   _____

3. Why does Govinda doubt that Siddhartha is a pilgrim?

   _____

   _____

4. Does Govinda recognize him at first?

5. What does Siddhartha promise himself he will never do again?
6. Retell the three most important events of "By the River" in order, in one sentence each.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "By the River"? Name two and one thing each says or does.
8. Where and when does "By the River" take place? Point to the line that tells you.
9. Reread: "These had been his possession, his power and strength, his solid staff; in the busy, laborious years of his youth, he had learned these three feats, nothing else." What does "laborious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?
10. Reread: "And how could he not have loved everybody and everything in this moment, in the glorious hour after his wonderful sleep, filled with Om!" What does "glorious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

Inferential

1. What does "By the River" suggest about despair and renewal by the river? State the inference and the line that supports it.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about despair and renewal by the river?

4. In the passage that begins “For a long time, he pondered his transformation, listened to the bird, as it sang for joy.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “By the River”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “By the River” build on “Sansara”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the unity of all things?

10. Background: Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of “By the River” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about despair and renewal by the river?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about “By the River”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the river and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how “By the River” treats despair and renewal by the river with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

8. Predict what “The Ferryman” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about despair and renewal by the river?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Chapter quiz

1. Which word completes this sentence from By the River, paragraph 12? “Siddhartha _____ up, then he saw a person sitting opposite to him, an unknown man, a monk in a yellow robe with a shaven head, sitting in the position of pondering.”
   A. tore
   B. straightened
   C. summed
   D. overstretched
2. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In those days, so he remembered, he had _____ of three things to Kamala, had been able to do three noble and undefeatable feats: fasting—waiting—thinking.”
   Word bank: wept, boasted, slept, eaten
   Answer: _____
3. Complete the quotation from By the River, paragraph 8: “Om! he spoke to himself: Om! and again he knew about Brahman, knew about the _____ of life, knew about all that is divine, which he had forgotten.”
   Word bank: cheapness, dullness, pointlessness, indestructibility
   Answer: _____
4. Who watches over Siddhartha while he sleeps by the river?
   A. Kamaswami, the merchant from the city
   B. The oldest Samana of the forest
   C. Govinda, the Brahmin's son
   D. Kamala, the courtesan

5. Complete the quotation from By the River, paragraph 1: "Deeply, he had been _____ in Sansara, he had sucked up disgust and death from all sides into his body, like a sponge sucks up water until it is full"
   Answer: _____
6. Which word completes this sentence from By the River, paragraph 31? "Not eternal is the world of _____"
   A. yesterday
   B. everlasting
   C. appearances
   D. Atman
7. Complete the quotation from By the River, paragraph 14: "I, O sir, am a follower of the exalted Gotama, the Buddha, the Sakyamuni, and have been on a _____ together with several of us on this path, when I saw you lying and sleeping in a place where it is dangerous to sleep."
   Word bank: raid, spree, binge, pilgrimage
   Answer: _____
8. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Wonderfully, soon afterwards, insight came towards me in the form of the great Buddha's teachings, I felt the knowledge of the _____ of the world circling in me like my own blood."
   Word bank: ugliness, oneness, division, price
   Answer: _____
9. In the line "But as a young man, I followed the penitents, lived in the forest, suffered of heat and frost, learned to hunger, taught my body to become dead.", what does "penitents" most nearly mean?
   A. people who punish themselves for their sins
   B. a woman paid to be the companion of wealthy men
   C. in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering
   D. a message informing of danger
10. Which of these passages comes earliest in By the River?
    A. "Siddhartha saw that Govinda did not recognise him."
    B. "his dormant spirit suddenly woke up"
    C. "he also saw the river going downhill, always moving on downhill"
    D. "And yet, this path has been very good"
11. What can you infer from this line? "And full he was, full of the feeling of been sick of it, full of misery, full of death, there was nothing left in this world which could have attracted him, given him joy, given him comfort." (By the River, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
12. Analyze the word choice in "I had to pass through so much stupidity, through so much vices, through so many errors, through so much disgust and disappointment and woe, just to become a child again and to be able to start over." (By the River, paragraph 42). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    _____

13. Which literary element does this describe in "By the River"? At the river Siddhartha comes close to ending his life (By the River, paras. 2–5, referenced only); the word Om rises from his inner self and stops him, showing who he truly is beneath his despair.
    A. Simile
    B. Characterization
    C. Metaphor
    D. Setting
14. Analyze how the word choice in this passage from By the River, paragraph 40 shapes its tone: "But he could not feel sad about this, no, he even felt a great urge to laugh, to laugh about himself, to laugh about this strange, foolish world." Use one more quotation from the chapter.
15. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Now, Siddhartha smiled" (By the River, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Writing prompt

Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

Lesson 10: The Ferryman

Focus: learning from the river

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
obstructing	*They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.*	
precocious	*They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.*	
ferried	*Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*	
oarsman	*The rich and elegant Siddhartha is becoming an oarsman's servant, the learned Brahmin Siddhartha becomes a ferryman: this has also been told to you by the river.*	
wondrously	*He looked up and first saw the boy's face, which wondrously reminded him of something, like a warning to remember something he had forgotten.*	
birthplace	*Listening carefully, he let everything enter his mind, birthplace and childhood, all that learning, all that searching, all joy, all distress.*	
singsong	*And with that singsong, the boy became calm, was only now and then uttering a sob and fell asleep.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. What does the passenger say about the ferryman's life by the river?

   _____

   _____

2. What is Vasudeva's greatest skill?

   _____

   _____

3. What does the river teach about time?

   _____

   _____

4. Whom does Kamala point out to Siddhartha before she loses consciousness, and what does she tell him?

   _____

   _____

5. How does the boy feel about the journey with his mother?

6. Retell the three most important events of "The Ferryman" in order, in one sentence each.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Ferryman"? Name two and one thing each says or does.
8. Where and when does "The Ferryman" take place? Point to the line that tells you.
9. Reread: "Siddhartha rose, the workings of hunger in his body became unbearable." What does "unbearable" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?
10. Reread: "Her consciousness returned, she lay on Siddhartha's bed in the hut and bent over her stood Siddhartha, who used to love her so much." What does "consciousness" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

Inferential

1. What does "The Ferryman" suggest about learning from the river? State the inference and the line that supports it.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about learning from the river?
4. In the passage that begins "'Now I recognise you,'", why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

_____

5. What causes the main turn in “The Ferryman”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. How does “The Ferryman” build on “By the River”? Name one link of cause and effect.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the river teach that no person could?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the river and time?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
10. Background: The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____

_____

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Ferryman" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about learning from the river?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

4. Write three questions of your own about "The Ferryman": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

5. Connect this chapter to love and attachment: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

7. Compare how "The Ferryman" treats learning from the river with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

8. Predict what "The Son" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about learning from the river?

_____

_____

_____

_____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

_____

_____

_____

_____

Chapter quiz

1. In the line “They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman’s job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.”, what does “obstructing” most nearly mean?

   A. making by lacing strips or threads together

   B. washing or soaking in water

   C. blocking; standing in the way

   D. taking part in; sharing

2. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He looked up and first saw the boy’s face, which _____ reminded him of something, like a warning to remember something he had forgotten.”

   Word bank: wondrously, cruelly, angrily, boringly

   Answer: _____

3. Complete the quotation from The Ferryman, paragraph 3: “Great be he who would grasp this, _____ this!”

   Word bank: sweep, understand, paint, cook

   Answer: _____

4. In the line “Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.”, what does “ferried” most nearly mean?

   A. transported from one shore to the other

   B. played games of chance for money

   C. longed for something strongly

   D. made a loud ringing noise

5. Complete the quotation from The Ferryman, paragraph 25: “But when Siddhartha fell silent, and a long _____ had occurred, then Vasudeva said:”

   Word bank: silence, gravel, plaster, sawdust

   Answer: _____

6. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?

   A. Gotama's

   B. Kamaswami's

   C. Govinda's

D. Vasudeva's

7. Who stays with Siddhartha after Kamala dies?
   A. Their young son
   B. Gotama, the teacher in the grove
   C. Kamaswami, the merchant
   D. Govinda, the Brahmin's son
8. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Listening carefully, he let everything enter his mind, _____ and childhood, all that learning, all that searching, all joy, all distress.”
   Word bank: marketplace, birthplace, warehouse, merchandise
   Answer: _____
9. How is Kamala hurt?
   A. She is bitten by a snake
   B. She falls into the river from the boat
   C. She catches fever
   D. She is robbed
10. Complete the quotation from The Ferryman, paragraph 34: “that the river is _____ at once, at the source and at the mouth, at the waterfall, at the ferry, at the rapids, in the sea, in the mountains”
    Answer: _____
11. Which of these passages comes earliest in The Ferryman?
    A. “He understood and grasped it not, only felt some idea of it stirring, a distant memory, divine voices.”
    B. “he today only saw one, this one touched his soul.”
    C. “In a daze he walked on, up the path by the bank, upriver, listened to the current, listened to the rumbling hunger in his body.”
    D. “He saw: this water ran and ran, incessantly it ran, and was nevertheless always there, was always at all times the same and yet new in…”
12. What does the river teach Siddhartha in this passage? “See, you’ve already learned this from the water too, that it is good to strive downwards, to sink, to seek depth.” (The Ferryman, paragraph 27)
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
    _____
13. Which literary element does this describe in “The Ferryman”? Siddhartha joins Vasudeva the ferryman, who is a perfect listener and says the river taught him everything.
    A. Allusion
    B. Theme
    C. Irony
    D. Characterization
14. Synthesis: trace how the river and time develops from By the River to The Ferryman. Use one quotation from each.
    _____

15. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "How did he love this water, how did it delight him, how grateful was he to it!" (The Ferryman, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Writing prompt

Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

Lesson 11: The Son

Focus: the pain of a father's love

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
reciprocate	*For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.*	
ranting	*"I must follow him," said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.*	
soiling	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	
burdening	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	
exuberant	*Won't he become exuberant, won't he lose himself to pleasure and power, won't he repeat all of his father's mistakes, won't he perhaps get entirely lost in Sansara?"*	
thumped	*But the boy did not leave the hut, in stubborn disobedience and rage he stayed where he was, thumped on the ground with his feet, clenched his fists, and screamed in a powerful outburst his hatred and contempt into his father's face.*	
humiliate	*Through all this, the son let him commit his foolish acts, let him court for his affection, let him humiliate himself every day by giving in to his moods.*	
warnings	*Were his father's religious devotion, his teachers warnings, his own knowledge, his own search able to keep him safe?*	
enriched	*Now he too felt, late, once in his lifetime, this strongest and strangest of all passions, suffered from it, suffered miserably, and was nevertheless in bliss, was nevertheless renewed in one respect, enriched by one thing.*	
admonition	*By means of teachings, prayer, admonition?*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Which line of Kamala's does Siddhartha remember when the boy's face reminds him of her?

   _____

   _____

2. What image does Vasudeva use for the boy's old life?

3. What does the boy do after his outburst of rage?
4. What does Siddhartha ask Vasudeva when they set out with the raft?
5. What does Siddhartha feel at the garden gate instead of the goal he hoped for?
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Son" in order, in one sentence each.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Son"? Name two and one thing each says or does.
8. Where and when does "The Son" take place? Point to the line that tells you.
9. Reread: "For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it." What does "reciprocate" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?
10. Reread: "'I must follow him,' said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday." What does "ranting" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

Inferential

1. What does "The Son" suggest about the pain of a father's love? State the inference and the line that supports it.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the pain of a father's love?

4. In the passage that begins “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “The Son”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “The Son” build on “The Ferryman”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does the theme of love and attachment appear most clearly in this chapter, and how does it connect to the rest of the book?

10. Background: This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

_____
_____
_____

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Son” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the pain of a father's love?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Son”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the search for self-knowledge: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how “The Son” treats the pain of a father's love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____

_____

_____

_____

8. Predict what “Om” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

_____

_____

_____

_____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the pain of a father's love?

_____

_____

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10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

_____

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_____

Chapter quiz

1. What does Vasudeva advise?
   A. Lock him up in the hut
   B. Punish him for running away
   C. Let the boy go into the world
   D. Send him to the monks in Gotama's grove
2. How does the son treat Siddhartha?
   A. With silence
   B. With contempt
   C. With love
   D. With fear and awe
3. Which word completes this sentence from The Son, paragraph 2? “He did not force him, he did many a chore for him, _____ picked the best piece of the meal for him.”
   A. always
   B. sideways
   C. loudly
   D. backwards
4. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Were his father’s religious devotion, his teachers _____, his own knowledge, his own search able to keep him safe?”

Word bank: debts, warnings, salaries, robes

Answer: _____

5. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But the boy did not leave the hut, in stubborn disobedience and rage he stayed where he was, _____ on the ground with his feet, clenched his fists, and screamed in a powerful outburst his hatred and contempt into his father’s face.”

   Word bank: danced, thumped, slept, knelt

   Answer: _____

6. What is ironic about Siddhartha's pain?

   A. He forgets the boy and returns to the city of his youth

   B. He becomes rich from the ferry

   C. He is happy to be alone again

   D. He now feels the attachment he once called childlike

7. Where does Siddhartha go in pursuit?

   A. To the mountains where the Samanas live

   B. To his father's house

   C. To the city and Kamala's old garden

   D. To Gotama's grove

8. Which word completes this sentence from The Son, paragraph 5? “But the river laughs, it laughs at me, it laughs at you and me, and is shaking with laughter at our _____.”

   A. foolishness

   B. oars

   C. hut

   D. fare

9. What can you infer from this line? “You cannot love” (The Son, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. Which of these passages comes earliest in The Son?

    A. “Pale, he sat for many days by the hill of the dead, did not want to eat, gave no open look, did not open his heart, met his fate with…”

    B. “gloomy and shy, he had listened to Siddhartha”

    C. “Siddhartha spared him and let him do as he pleased, he honoured his mourning.”

    D. “Siddhartha understood that his son did not know him, that he could not love him like a father.”

11. Which choice best states a central concern of “The Son”?

    A. The pain of a father's love

    B. Despair and renewal by the river

    C. Entering the city and learning love

D. Detachment among the childlike people

12. What warning does Vasudeva give Siddhartha about his son? “Don’t you shackle him with your love?” (The Son, paragraph 10)

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

13. What does Vasudeva mean, and how does it apply to Siddhartha's own past? “Who has kept the Samana Siddhartha safe from Sansara, from sin, from greed,…” (The Son, paragraph 14)

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

14. Which literary element does this describe in “The Son”? Siddhartha's son is spoiled and resentful; Siddhartha loves him blindly and cannot let him go.

A. Characterization

B. Imagery

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Hyperbole

15. Which literary element does this describe in “The Son”? The hut and the field by the river, where the two old men split the work and the boy refuses to settle.

A. Allusion

B. Setting

C. Simile

D. Point of view

Writing prompt

Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Lesson 12: Om

Focus: hearing the many voices

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
blossomed	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	
fateful	*Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?*	
ferryboat	*He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*	
ripened	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	
nurtured	*But the wound still burned, longingly and bitterly Siddhartha thought of his son, nurtured his love and tenderness in his heart, allowed the pain to gnaw at him, committed all foolish acts of love.*	
runaway	*He presented his wound, also told how he fled today, how he ferried across the water, a childish runaway, willing to walk to the city, how the river had laughed.*	
resounded	*It still resounded, full of suffering, searching, but other voices joined it, voices of joy and of suffering, good and bad voices, laughing and sad ones, a hundred voices, a thousand voices.*	
bathing	*To show his wound to this listener was the same as bathing it in the river, until it had cooled and become one with the river.*	
weaving	*Vasudeva was sitting in the hut and weaving a basket.*	
solemnity	*With deep joy, with deep solemnity he watched him leave, saw his steps full of peace, saw his head full of lustre, saw his body full of light.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?

   _____

   _____

2. What is Vasudeva doing in the hut when Siddhartha comes back from the river?

   _____

   _____

3. Whose images does Siddhartha see merge in the river as he listens better?

4. What does Siddhartha feel flowing over to Vasudeva as he speaks?
5. What does Vasudeva see shining in Siddhartha's eyes when he rises from the seat by the bank?
6. Retell the three most important events of "Om" in order, in one sentence each.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Om"? Name two and one thing each says or does.
8. Where and when does "Om" take place? Point to the line that tells you.
9. Reread: "Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva's old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness." What does "harmony" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?
10. Reread: "Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?" What does "repetition" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

Inferential

1. What does "Om" suggest about hearing the many voices? State the inference and the line that supports it.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about hearing the many voices?

4. In the passage that begins “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “Om”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “Om” build on “The Son”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

10. Background: Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: "The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of "Om" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about hearing the many voices?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about "Om": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to experience versus teaching: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how "Om" treats hearing the many voices with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

8. Predict what "Govinda" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about hearing the many voices?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Chapter quiz

1. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But the wound still burned, longingly and bitterly Siddhartha thought of his son, _____ his love and tenderness in his heart, allowed the pain to gnaw at him, committed all foolish acts of love."

   Word bank: nurtured, forgot, sold, spent

   Answer: _____

2. Which word completes this sentence from Om, paragraph 4? "Not by itself, this _____ would go out."

   A. river

   B. path

   C. boat

   D. flame

3. In the line "Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?", what does "fateful" most nearly mean?

   A. bringing doom; leading to an unhappy end

   B. original; existing from the very beginning

   C. strikingly unusual or odd

   D. occurring or operating at the same time

4. What does Vasudeva do afterward?

   A. Becomes a monk

   B. Leaves for the city to find his own son

   C. Takes a new boat

   D. Goes into the forests, into the oneness

5. Which word completes this sentence from Om, paragraph 19? "Brightly, Vasudeva's smile was shining, floating _____ over all the wrinkles of his old face, as the Om was floating in the air over all the voices of the river."
   A. gloomily
   B. radiantly
   C. harshly
   D. coldly
6. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He presented his wound, also told how he fled today, how he ferried across the water, a childish _____, willing to walk to the city, how the river had laughed."
   Word bank: king, runaway, priest, merchant
   Answer: _____
7. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It still _____, full of suffering, searching, but other voices joined it, voices of joy and of suffering, good and bad voices, laughing and sad ones, a hundred voices, a thousand voices."
   Word bank: laughed, rejoiced, resounded, celebrated
   Answer: _____
8. Complete the quotation from Om, paragraph 1: "For a long time, the wound _____ to burn."
   Word bank: salted, continued, painted, folded
   Answer: _____
9. What do all the river's voices become?
   A. Only silence
   B. His son's voice
   C. The single word Om
   D. A song of war and victory
10. Complete the quotation from Om, paragraph 17: "He was now nothing but a listener, completely concentrated on listening, completely _____"
    Word bank: noisy, distracted, chattering, empty
    Answer: _____
11. Complete the quotation from Om, paragraph 13: "Siddhartha looked into the water, and images _____ to him in the moving water"
    Word bank: appeared, remembered, started, smiled
    Answer: _____
12. Which choice best states a central concern of "Om"?
    A. Detachment among the childlike people
    B. Self-denial as a path
    C. Hearing the many voices
    D. Entering the city and learning love
13. What does Siddhartha see in the river, and why does it matter? "It resembled his father's face, the Brahmin." (Om, paragraph 5)

    _____

    _____

14. Analyze the word choice in “he understood them, he understood” (Om, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

15. Synthesis: trace how unity of opposites develops from The Son to Om. Use one quotation from each.

Writing prompt

Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

Lesson 13: Govinda

Focus: wisdom cannot be taught

Vocabulary

Word	In context	What it means here (your words)
insights	*But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?*	
benevolently	*The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.*	
searcher	*Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*	
bizarre	*(But secretly he thought to himself: This Siddhartha is a bizarre person, he expresses bizarre thoughts, his teachings sound foolish.*	
progressed	*It is not possible for any person to see how far another one has already progressed on his path; in the robber and dice-gambler, the Buddha is waiting; in the Brahmin, the robber is waiting.*	
simultaneous	*In deep meditation, there is the possibility to put time out of existence, to see all life which was, is, and will be as if it was simultaneous, and there everything is good, everything is perfect, everything is Brahman.*	
incarnation	*It is unlikely for one of us to see the other again in this incarnation.*	
predecessor	*But most of all, I have learned here from this river and from my predecessor, the ferryman Vasudeva.*	

Tiered discussion questions

Recall

1. Who comes to the ferry at the end?

   _____

   _____

2. What does Siddhartha say about wisdom?

   _____

   _____

3. What does Siddhartha say one must do with the world?

   _____

   _____

4. What does Govinda see in Siddhartha's face?

_____

_____

5. Whose smile does Siddhartha's resemble?

   _____

   _____

6. Retell the three most important events of "Govinda" in order, in one sentence each.

   _____

   _____

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Govinda"? Name two and one thing each says or does.

   _____

   _____

8. Where and when does "Govinda" take place? Point to the line that tells you.

   _____

   _____

9. Reread: "But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?" What does "insights" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

   _____

   _____

10. Reread: "The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one." What does "benevolently" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line?

    _____

    _____

Inferential

1. What does "Govinda" suggest about the idea that wisdom cannot be taught? State the inference and the line that supports it.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the idea that wisdom cannot be taught?

   _____

   _____

   _____

4. In the passage that begins “He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: ‘You’re very good to us monks and pilgrims,…’”, why might Hesse have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations.

5. What causes the main turn in “Govinda”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows?

6. How does “Govinda” build on “Om”? Name one link of cause and effect.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim?

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with experience versus teaching?

10. Background: The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter?

Evaluative

1. A critic might argue: “The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
3. Rewrite one moment of “Govinda” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the idea that wisdom cannot be taught?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
4. Write three questions of your own about “Govinda”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
5. Connect this chapter to the unity of all things: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hesse need to show next to strengthen it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review.
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
7. Compare how “Govinda” treats the idea that wisdom cannot be taught with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Siddhartha see that the other misses?
   _____
   _____
   _____

_____

8. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve experience versus teaching? Argue whether the ending is earned.

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the idea that wisdom cannot be taught?

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

10. What question would you most like to ask Hermann Hesse about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives?

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Chapter quiz

1. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It is not possible for any person to see how far another one has already _____ on his path; in the robber and dice-gambler, the Buddha is waiting; in the Brahmin, the robber is waiting."

   Word bank: slept, progressed, eaten, wept

   Answer: _____

2. Which word completes this sentence from Govinda, paragraph 8? "I don't quite understand yet," _____ Govinda.

   A. sang

   B. sneezed

   C. asked

   D. yawned

3. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But most of all, I have learned here from this river and from my _____, the ferryman Vasudeva."

   Word bank: enemy, servant, predecessor, creditor

   Answer: _____

4. What does Govinda ask about the "things" Siddhartha says he loves?

   A. Whether they are real

   B. Whether they can be sold

   C. Whether Gotama owned them

   D. Whether they will last forever

5. What does Siddhartha pick up from the ground to explain his thought to Govinda?
   A. A leaf
   B. A stone
   C. A cup of water
   D. An oar
6. Which word completes this sentence from Govinda, paragraph 28? "But when this holy man went into the forests, he knew _____, knew more than you and me, without teachers, without books, only because he had believed in the river."
   A. nothing
   B. only a little
   C. everything
   D. less
7. In the line "Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?", what does "searcher" most nearly mean?
   A. beginners in a religious order
   B. a gentle scolding or warning
   C. one who is on a quest for something
   D. understandings; realizations
8. In the line "But secretly he thought to himself: This Siddhartha is a bizarre person, he expresses bizarre thoughts, his teachings sound foolish.", what does "bizarre" most nearly mean?
   A. strikingly unusual or odd
   B. original; existing from the very beginning
   C. acting too quickly
   D. joyously unrestrained
9. Which word completes this sentence from Govinda, paragraph 17? "There have been many thoughts, but it would be hard for me to _____ them to you."
   A. swallow
   B. plant
   C. convey
   D. paint
10. Complete the quotation from Govinda, paragraph 15: "I've also learned from him, I'm also _____ to him"
    Word bank: grateful, rusty, muddy, wooden
    Answer: _____
11. Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It is unlikely for one of us to see the other again in this _____."
    Word bank: market, incarnation, auction, warehouse
    Answer: _____
12. Which choice best states a central concern of "Govinda"?
    A. Wisdom cannot be taught
    B. Self-denial as a path

C. Awakening to the world

D. Despair and renewal by the river

13. How does Siddhartha explain why a searcher fails to find? “the only thing his eyes still see is that what he searches for, that he is unable to find anything” (Govinda, paragraph 7)

14. What is Siddhartha's main claim to Govinda, and how does it echo his earlier argument with the Buddha? “It can be found, it can be lived, it is possible to be carried by it, miracles can be performed with it, but it cannot be expressed in words and taught.” (Govinda, paragraph 19)

15. Synthesis: trace how Siddhartha’s idea of where teachers are found develops from With the Samanas to Govinda. Use one quotation from each.

Writing prompt

Analyze how Govinda develops the idea that wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.) (450 words)

_____

_____

_____

_____

Unit test

Siddhartha: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions

1. Complete the quotation from The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 8: “But where, where was this self, this _____ part, this ultimate part”
   Answer: _____

2. In the line “Not proper it is for a Brahmin to speak harsh and angry words.”, what does “harsh” most nearly mean?
   A. rough and unkind
   B. soft and gentle
   C. quick and clever
   D. quiet and shy

3. All the people around the Brahmin’s son take joy in him. In whom does he find no pleasure?
   A. His father
   B. Govinda
   C. Himself
   D. His mother

4. Fill in the blank with the word that fits: “He was a source of joy for everybody, he was a _____ for them all.”
   Word bank: burden, delight, stranger, warning
   Answer: _____

5. How does Siddhartha win his father's permission?
   A. By running away
   B. By fasting for a month
   C. By standing silently all night
   D. By arguing loudly with his father for days

6. Who is waiting by the last hut to join Siddhartha as he leaves the town at dawn?
   A. Govinda, the Brahmin's son
   B. Vasudeva, a quiet man
   C. Kamaswami, the merchant
   D. Gotama, the teacher in the grove

7. In the line “long nails grew slowly on his parched fingers and a dry, shaggy beard grew on his chin”, what does “parched” most nearly mean?
   A. very wet
   B. very cold
   C. very dry
   D. very clean

8. As he wakes renewed by the river, what does Siddhartha feel singing in his chest?
   A. A drum

B. A bell

C. A bird

D. A flute

9. Fill in the blank with the word that fits. Looking back on his "stupidity" and "errors," Siddhartha thinks: "I had to become a _____, to find Atman in me again. I had to sin, to be able to live again."

   Word bank: saint, fool, king, priest

   Answer: _____

10. Fill in the blank with the word that fits: "Dead was the singing bird, he had _____ of. Dead was the bird in his heart."

    Word bank: eaten, dreamt, sold, built

    Answer: _____

11. After the boy takes the boat, what do Siddhartha and Vasudeva build to cross the river?

    A. A bridge of stones

    B. A rope across the water

    C. A second ferry boat

    D. A raft of bamboo

12. What does the new Siddhartha feel for the rushing water when he wakes?

    A. A deep love that keeps him near it

    B. Fear that it will carry him off

    C. Disgust at its muddy colour

    D. Indifference, since he means to leave

13. In the line "There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.", what does "ointments" most nearly mean?

    A. tricks; false appearances

    B. perfumed oils and creams

    C. a person who has run away

    D. steadiness of mind under stress

14. Where does Govinda sleep the night he stays at the ferry?

    A. In a guest house in the town

    B. On the bed that used to be Vasudeva's

    C. Under a tree beside the river

    D. In the ferryboat by the bank

15. In the line "my river has been nothing but an obstacle on their travels.", what does "obstacle" most nearly mean?

    A. a person left stranded after a shipwreck

    B. a trait of dignified seriousness

    C. something that blocks the way

    D. people who punish themselves for their sins

16. In the line “And do you, sir, intend to continue travelling without clothes?”, what does “intend” most nearly mean?

    A. forget

    B. plan; mean

    C. refuse

    D. pretend

17. Complete the quotation from The Ferryman, paragraph 35: “Nothing was, nothing will be; everything is, everything has existence and is _____.”

    Answer: _____

18. Fill in the blank with the word that fits: “With a smile, the man at the _____ moved from side to side:”

    Word bank: oar, kettle, ladder, pebble

    Answer: _____

19. What does Kamala tell Siddhartha about the boy’s eyes?

    A. That the boy has his mother’s eyes

    B. That the boy’s eyes are failing

    C. That in the eyes the boy is like him

    D. That the boy’s eyes are full of anger

20. Complete the quotation from By the River, paragraph 48: “his self had retreated, there it sat firmly and grew, while he thought he would kill it by fasting and _____.”

    Word bank: penance, laughter, velvet, harvest

    Answer: _____

21. In By the River, what does Siddhartha realise had been his sickness before?

    A. That he could not love anybody or anything

    B. That he had eaten too little as a Samana

    C. That he trusted Kamaswami too much

    D. That he had left Govinda behind

22. In the line “and again he knew about Brahman, knew about the indestructibility of life”, what does “indestructibility” most nearly mean?

    A. the quality of being impossible to destroy

    B. a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service

    C. a person left stranded after a shipwreck

    D. a message informing of danger

23. Kamala lists many ways love can be obtained (Kamala, paragraph 37). What is the one way it cannot be obtained?

    A. By begging for it

    B. By stealing it

    C. By buying it

    D. By finding it in the street

24. What does Siddhartha discover about his Samana exercises of leaving the self?

    A. Every path away from it ended where it began.

B. The self can be destroyed for good by enough fasting and pain.

C. Only the oldest Samana has escaped the self.

D. The self is best found through obedience.

25. What can you infer from this line? "You've heard the teachings, O son of a Brahmin, and good for you that you've thought about it thus deeply" (Gotama, paragraph 36) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

26. What does this passage most clearly show? "I want to learn from myself, want to be my student, want to get to know myself, the secret of Siddhartha." (Awakening, paragraph 6)

A. He plans to return to the Buddha and become one of his pupils after all.

B. He turns from outside teachers to his own experience.

C. He wants to teach the Samanas what he has found.

D. He longs to go back to his father's house.

27. What can you infer from this line? "This too, I have learned from the river: everything is coming back" (Kamala, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

28. What does this passage most clearly show? "I was a rich man and am no rich man any more, and what I'll be tomorrow, I don't know." (By the River, paragraph 33)

A. He accepts his loss without knowing what comes next.

B. He plans to win back his wealth in the city.

C. He fears that Govinda will now reject him.

D. He wants the monks to tell him his future.

29. What can you infer from this line? "He had died, a new Siddhartha had woken up from the sleep." (By the River, paragraph 48) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

30. What can you infer from this line? "he wanted to learn from it, he wanted to listen to it." (The Ferryman, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

31. What does this passage most clearly show? "Even bad people, even thieves and robbers have children and love them, and are being loved by them, all except for me." (Om, paragraph 1)

    A. His scorn for thieves and robbers who pass by.

    B. His plan to steal back his son from the city.

    C. His relief that he no longer has to love.

    D. His grief makes him envy the plainest of parents.

32. What can you infer from this line? "everything came back, which had not been suffered and solved up to its end" (Om, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

33. What does this passage most clearly show? "In this pointless cycle he ran, growing tired, growing old, growing ill." (Sansara, paragraph 7)

    A. His business is growing faster than ever.

    B. His worldly life has become a wearing, empty loop.

    C. He has found peace in his garden at last.

    D. His illness comes from a fever caught by the river.

34. What can you infer from this line? "Kamala owned a small, rare singing bird in a golden cage." (Sansara, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

35. What does this passage most clearly show? "But today I think: this stone is a stone, it is also animal, it is also god, it is also Buddha" (Govinda, paragraph 23)

    A. Everything holds the divine within it at once.

    B. He has lost his faith in the Buddha.

    C. He wants Govinda to worship stones.

    D. He thinks stones are worth more than people.

36. Analyze the word choice in "What I've learned, being among the Samanas, up to this day, this, O Govinda, I could have learned more quickly and by simpler means" (With the Samanas, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

37. Which literary element does this describe in "Gotama"? The Buddha's alms-dish and yellow robe stand for a life of begging and giving things up.
    A. Simile
    B. Characterization
    C. Alliteration
    D. Symbolism
38. Which literary element does this describe in "Awakening"? Siddhartha calls the world a book whose colours and forms are letters he must learn to read.
    A. Foreshadowing
    B. Conflict
    C. Metaphor
    D. Plot
39. Which literary element does this describe in "Kamala"? Kamala arranges for him to meet Kamaswami, the richest merchant, the first step into trade.
    A. Symbolism
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Conflict
    D. Personification
40. Which literary element does this describe in "With the Childlike People"? Siddhartha handles his deals as a ballplayer handles his balls, tossing them about for amusement.
    A. Alliteration
    B. Simile
    C. Hyperbole
    D. Theme
41. Which literary element does this describe in "By the River"? Despair, sleep, awakening: the chapter repeats the pattern of 'Awakening' (an ending followed by a new beginning), now as rebirth from despair.
    A. Imagery
    B. Structure
    C. Simile
    D. Conflict
42. Which literary element does this describe in "Govinda"? In place of Siddhartha's face, Govinda sees the faces of a dying fish, a newborn child and a murderer flow past him.
    A. Imagery
    B. Structure
    C. Point of view
    D. Alliteration

43. In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Siddhartha feels the indestructibility of every life and the eternity of every moment.

    A. The search for self-knowledge

    B. Experience versus teaching

    C. Wealth and its cost

    D. The oneness of every being

44. Analyze the word choice in "He said nothing and waited; daily, he began the mute struggle of friendliness, the silent war of patience." (The Son, paragraph 16). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

45. Synthesis: trace how the search for the self develops from the opening of "The Son of the Brahmin" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

46. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "filled his heart with anger, filled his heart with unrest, filled his heart with anguish" (The Son of the Brahmin, paragraph 31) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

47. Synthesis: trace how Siddhartha's trust in himself develops from Awakening to By the River. Use one quotation from each. Address one competing reading and answer it.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

48. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "And now, they had abandoned him, none of them was his any more, neither fasting, nor waiting, nor thinking." (By the River, paragraph 38) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

_____

49. Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I have transported many, thousands; and to all of them, my river has been nothing but an obstacle on their travels." (The Ferryman, paragraph 29) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

50. Synthesis: trace how Vasudeva's patient silence develops from The Ferryman to The Son. Use one quotation from each. Address one competing reading and answer it.

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

    _____

Final paper

Siddhartha: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Siddhartha and argue how its meaning changes over the novel and why that change matters to experience versus teaching.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Siddhartha. Argue whether the novel judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether the novel finally endorses Siddhartha's vision of the unity of all things or presents it as one man's experience. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: 900-1,100 words

Criterion	Points	What it looks like
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and APA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: The search for self-knowledge

Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim. (1000 words)

Essay: Experience versus teaching

Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim. (1000 words)

Essay: The unity of all things

Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim. (1000 words)

Essay: The river and time

Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim. (1000 words)

Essay: Love and attachment

Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim. (1000 words)